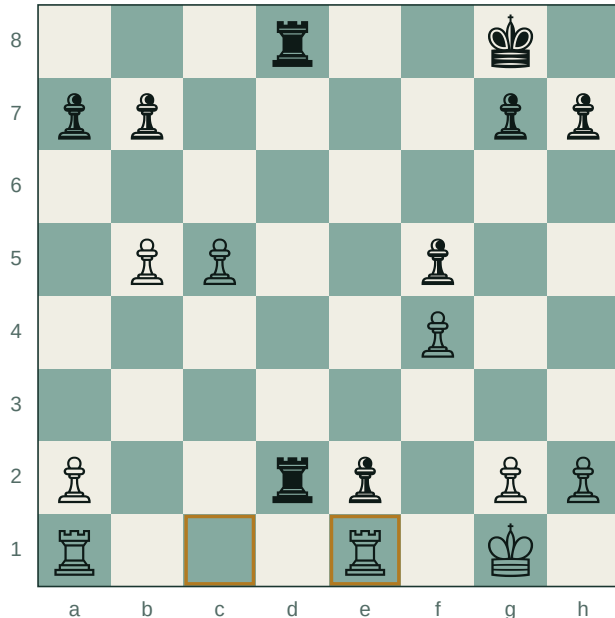


Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 26

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 26.Re1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26...Rd1 27. Kf2 Rxa1

26...Rd1 The rook moves from d2 to d1. From d1 it attacks rook on e1 and rook on a1. Recorded reply: **27.Kf2**.

27...Rxa1 The rook captures the rook on a1.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.